



● ELITE PLAN · \$34.99/MONTH

21-DAY PROGRAMME

MEDITATION AND MINDFULNESS

Strong mind, strong body. Three weeks of guided practice designed for people who **train seriously**.

21 DAYS

2 FULL SCRIPTS

3 BREATHING TECHNIQUES

PRACTICE LOG



ATTENTION
Paced breathing

21

GUIDED PRACTICES

5-20

MINUTES A DAY

2

WORD-FOR-WORD
SCRIPTS

8

PAGES

WHY AN ATHLETE MEDITATES

This is not spirituality, nor «emptying your mind». It is training the ability to **direct your attention** and to drop the nervous system into recovery mode when it is time: two skills that transfer to the heavy set and to deep sleep.

WHAT YOU CAN EXPECT

- Falling asleep faster on stressful nights
- Better focus on the maximal set
- Less reactivity to a bad day in the gym or on the scale

WHAT IT IS NOT

- It does not replace psychological or psychiatric treatment
- It is not about emptying the mind: it is about coming back
- It does not work if you only practise when you feel bad

HOW THE PROGRAMME WORKS

01 One practice a day for 21 days

From 5 to 20 minutes, in order. Each day builds on the skill built the day before.

02 Same time, same place

A stable context is what turns practice into habit. Mornings, right after getting up, work for most people.

03 Losing the thread is the practice

Every time you notice you have drifted and come back, you have done one repetition. That is the training.

04 If you miss a day, carry on the next

Do not repeat the missed day and do not start over. Consistency matters more than perfection.

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To read out or record, word for word

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THE 21 DAYS, ONE BY ONE

DAY	TECHNIQUE	DURATION	WHAT IT INVOLVES	DONE
1	Conscious breathing	5 min	Observe your breath without trying to change it	☐
2	Breath counting	7 min	Count to 10 and start again. If you lose count, go back to 1	☐
3	Body scan	10 min	Move attention through every part of the body	☐
4	4-7-8 breathing	8 min	Inhale 4 s, hold 7 s, exhale 8 s	☐
5	Walking mindfulness	15 min	Every step with full attention on the foot landing	☐
6	Gratitude meditation	10 min	Three specific things you are grateful for	☐
7	Athletic visualisation	12 min	Mentally rehearse your perfect session	☐
8	Metta (loving-kindness)	10 min	Direct good wishes towards yourself and towards others	☐
9	Box breathing	10 min	4-4-4-4: inhale, hold, exhale, hold empty	☐
10	Deep body scan	15 min	Full progressive muscle relaxation	☐
11	Observing thoughts	10 min	Your thoughts are passing clouds; they are not you	☐
12	Mindfulness in the shower	5-10 min	Full attention to temperature, sound and touch	☐
13	Alternate nostril breathing	10 min	Nadi Shodhana: one nostril at a time	☐
14	Walking meditation	20 min	Walk outdoors with complete presence	☐
15	Goal visualisation	15 min	Your best self six months from now, in detail	☐
16	Athletic body scan	12 min	Attention to tension before and after training	☐
17	Advanced 4-7-8 breathing	12 min	Three cycles of ten full breaths	☐
18	Compassion meditation	12 min	Acknowledge your effort and your wins without demanding more	☐
19	Mindful eating	20 min	A whole meal with full attention to flavour	☐
20	Open awareness	15 min	Observe whatever arises, without judging or steering	☐
21	Free practice	20 min	Choose whichever technique resonated most	☐

WHAT TO DO ON DAY 22

Keep the **two or three practices** that worked best for you and turn them into routine: one in the morning for focus and one at night for rest. The programme does not end, it simplifies.

FULL BODY SCAN · 15 MIN

HOW TO USE IT

Read the text slowly, or record yourself reading it to play back later. Leave a **3-5 second pause** between paragraphs. Position: lying on your back, arms at your sides, eyes closed.

«Close your eyes. Let your body rest completely on the surface beneath you. Feel the weight of your body. You do not need to change anything, only to observe. Breathe naturally...»

«Bring your attention to the soles of your feet. Without judging, without changing, notice any sensation that is there: temperature, tension, contact. Stay here for a few moments...»

«Now move slowly up through the ankles, the calves, the knees. If you find tension, simply name it: tension, warmth, tingling. Then let it dissolve with each exhale...»

«Keep moving up towards the thighs, the hips, the abdomen. With each breath the abdomen rises and falls gently. You are aware of your body's natural rhythm...»

«Bring your attention to the chest and the heart. Feel the soft, steady beat. This heart has been beating your whole life, without a break. Feel gratitude for it...»

«Move up through the shoulders and the arms to the fingertips. Release any tension you have gathered during the day...»

«Finally, bring your attention to the neck, the jaw — unclench your teeth — the eyes and the forehead. Imagine each exhale carrying the day's tension away with it. Your body is heavy and relaxed...»

«When you are ready, gently move your fingers and your toes. Open your eyes slowly. Take a moment before getting up. Carry this calm with you into the rest of the day.»

A 5-MINUTE VARIANT FOR BEDTIME

Go through only four areas — feet, legs, torso and face — tensing each for 3 seconds and then releasing it completely. The contrast between tension and release is what teaches the body to let go for real.

ATHLETIC VISUALISATION · 12 MIN

WHEN TO USE IT

The night before an important session, or 30 minutes before training. Seated, back straight, eyes closed. Mental rehearsal works because it activates **the same neural pathways** as actually performing the movement.

«Sit comfortably, back straight and feet flat on the floor. Take three deep breaths: in through the nose, slowly out through the mouth. With each exhale, let go of the day's noise...»

«Imagine walking into the gym. Feel the temperature of the air, hear the background sound, smell the room. You are here with a clear purpose...»

«You see yourself warming up. The movements are fluid. You notice the body responding, the joint opening, the muscle waking up. Everything is in place...»

«Now you set up in front of the bar. You see the weight. It is demanding, and you are ready. You feel the texture of the grip in your hands, the firm placement of your feet against the floor...»

«You perform the first repetition. Perfect. You feel exactly which muscle is working, the controlled speed on the way down, the precise force on the way up. The technique is flawless...»

«Repetition after repetition, you hold the same quality. When fatigue appears, you recognise it without fear: it is part of the process. You breathe, you reset, you carry on...»

«You finish the last set. You feel the effort well spent, the satisfaction of having done what you set out to do. This is not luck: it is the consequence of your preparation...»

«Take one deep breath. Keep this feeling of control and carry it with you. When you open your eyes, your body already knows what it has to do.»

THE THREE RULES OF AN EFFECTIVE VISUALISATION

- **First person, not third.** Live it from behind your own eyes; do not watch yourself from outside as if on video.
- **Include every sense.** Touch, sound and muscular effort matter more than the visual image.
- **Rehearse the difficulty too.** Visualising only easy success does not prepare you for the moment the rep stalls.

THREE BREATHING TECHNIQUES

TECHNIQUE 1 · 4-7-8 BREATHING (ANTI-STRESS)

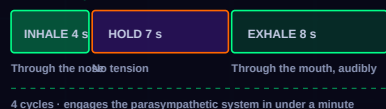
STEP	ACTION
1	Sit with your back straight or lie on your back
2	Exhale completely through the mouth, audibly
3	Close your mouth and inhale through the nose for a count of 4
4	Hold the breath for a count of 7
5	Exhale through the mouth for a count of 8
6	Repeat the cycle 3-4 times. Most effective right before sleep

If you feel dizzy, shorten the counts while keeping the 4-7-8 ratio.

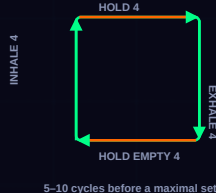
TECHNIQUE 2 · BOX BREATHING (FOCUS)

FIG. 1 THE PROGRAMME'S TWO BREATHING PATTERNS

4-7-8 TECHNIQUE · BEFORE SLEEP



BOX 4-4-4-4 · FOCUS



Each block's width is proportional to the actual seconds.

TECHNIQUE 3 · DIAPHRAGMATIC BREATHING (THE BASE)

01 Place your hands

One on the chest and one on the abdomen.

02 Inhale slowly

Only the hand on the abdomen should move.

03 Check the pattern

If the chest hand moves, you are breathing shallowly: the stress pattern.

04 10 breaths every morning

Before getting up. In 3-4 weeks it will be your natural pattern.

TAKE CARE WITH BREATH HOLDS

With uncontrolled hypertension, cardiac or respiratory conditions, pregnancy, or anxiety attacks involving hyperventilation, avoid prolonged holds and check with your doctor. Never practise them in water or while driving.

TAKE IT TO THE GYM AND THE TABLE

MOMENT	60-SECOND PRACTICE	WHAT IT IMPROVES
Before the heavy set	Three box breaths while looking at the bar	Lowers mental noise and improves activation
Between sets	Slow nasal breathing, counting the exhale	Speeds up recovery between efforts
When you finish training	Quick scan: which area stayed tense?	Catches compensations before they become injuries
Before eating	Three breaths and one question: am I actually hungry?	Tells physiological hunger from emotional hunger
During the meal	Put the cutlery down between mouthfuls	Improves satiety and digestion
Before sleep	Four cycles of 4-7-8	Shortens the time it takes you to fall asleep

YOUR 21-DAY LOG

WEEK	L	M	X	J	V	S	D	HOW I FELT
Week 1	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Week 2	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	
Week 3	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	

WHAT I LEARNED IN THESE THREE WEEKS

AN HONEST MEASURE OF PROGRESS

It is not «how long I last without drifting» but **how long it takes me to notice I have drifted**. That time shortens with practice, and it is exactly the skill you then use in real life.

WHERE EVERY NUMBER COMES FROM

Every number in this document comes from sources that are public, free and checkable. Not one figure is invented, rounded for convenience or copied from another popular publication. This page exists so that you can verify it yourself.

WHY THESE SOURCES AND NO OTHERS

Works of the United States federal government are not subject to copyright (17 U.S.C. § 105). That makes a handful of agencies the only source of nutrition and training data that is both first-rate and legally free. This is not restricted material: it is public material that almost nobody opens.

WHAT YOU ARE LOOKING FOR	WHAT YOU WILL FIND	WHERE
Reference intakes	RDA, AI and tolerable upper intake level for every vitamin and mineral	ods.od.nih.gov
Food composition	The full profile of any food, nutrient by nutrient	fdc.nal.usda.gov
Dietary guidelines	Dietary patterns and limits for added sugars, saturated fat and sodium	health.gov
Physical activity guidelines	The weekly dose, its response curve and the strength requirement	health.gov
Physical readiness doctrine	FM 7-22: training, nutrition, sleep and mental readiness	armypubs.army.mil
Lifting equation	How much weight is reasonable to lift in each specific situation	cdc.gov/niosh
Food safety	Safe internal temperatures and the danger zone	foodsafety.gov
Health claims	What may legally be claimed about a nutrient in Europe, and what was refused	European Commission register

HOW THIS DOCUMENT CHECKS ITSELF

The reference figures are not typed by hand: they live in a data module that the typesetting program verifies before writing a single line. It checks that the macronutrient ranges can add up to one hundred per cent of energy, that none of the 19 micronutrients has a recommended value above its own ceiling without a note explaining why, and that no safe cooking temperature falls inside the danger zone. If a single check fails, the document is not typeset.

REFERENCE VALUES ARE POPULATION VALUES

They describe what covers the needs of most healthy adults. They are not an individual prescription, they do not account for disease, pregnancy, breastfeeding or medication, and no publication replaces assessment by a registered health professional. If you take medication, some of the nutrients named here interact with it in clinically relevant ways: do not change an intake or start a supplement without telling whoever prescribes for you.

WHEN THE PRACTICE GETS STUCK

WHAT IS HAPPENING	WHY IT HAPPENS	WHAT TO DO
«I cannot stop thinking»	You are trying to empty your mind, which is not the goal	Every time you come back, you have done a repetition. That is the exercise
I fall asleep	You practise lying down and short on sleep	Practise sitting, with eyes half open, and not in bed
I get more anxious	When the outside noise drops, the inside noise appears	Switch to walking mindfulness or to the shower practice
I have no time	You are aiming at sessions that are too long	Three minutes daily beats twenty minutes once a week
I get bored	Expecting «something to happen»	Boredom can be observed too. It is usually the way in
Intense emotions come up	Silence makes room for what you had been covering up	Open your eyes, breathe and stop. If it recurs, speak to a professional

STRONG MIND, STRONG BODY

The 4-7-8 breathing on page 6 is the piece that **joins the practice to your rest**: use it every night and the programme keeps working while you sleep.

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IMPORTANT NOTICE

This programme is for informational and educational purposes about relaxation and mindfulness techniques. It does not constitute medical or psychological advice, is not a treatment and does not replace care from a registered health professional. Meditation must not be used as a substitute for therapy or prescribed medication. If you have severe anxiety, depression, post-traumatic stress disorder, or a psychotic or dissociative disorder, consult your mental health professional before starting; some intensive practices can worsen certain conditions. Stop the practice and seek professional help if intense psychological distress appears. Breathing techniques involving breath holds are contraindicated in uncontrolled hypertension, cardiac or respiratory conditions and pregnancy. Copyrighted content: reproduction, distribution or resale without written permission from VILLUMINATIONS is prohibited.